EUROPA POWER INITIATIVE

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For the first time since the Renaissance, Europeans and their partners are trapped in a world order structured by rivalry between systemic superpowers. These superpowers favour imperial power and the capture of resources that enable their technological domination, to the detriment of peace, justice and global balance.

This new order exposes Europe – like other regions – to the immediate risk of economic, technological, cultural and political marginalisation. It undermines the foundations of our society: freedom, democracy, pluralism, standard of living and quality of life, social protection, security and European values.

Faced with this existential threat, urgent action is essential: to reject any form of subservience, to regain control of our destiny and to build an ambition that is intelligible to Europeans and the world at large. The challenge is clear: not to suffer a fate decided elsewhere, but to collectively invent our own future.

We have all the means at our disposal to make Europe a power for the future. The ideas are there, fuelled by numerous reports which, until now, have been implemented only very slowly and very partially. We must now prioritise them and activate the levers at our disposal in key areas.

The first lever is the willingness of citizens to actively participate in writing a new, positive chapter in the history of our continent and to shape the future of European democracy.

The second lever is a market of 450 million inhabitants that must be used to serve an agenda of economic, industrial, technological, social and environmental development in our territories, the prosperity of all Europeans and the cohesion of Europe.

The third lever is massive savings of €35 trillion, which, thanks to the unified savings and investment market, ambitious growth prospects and rules that encourage risk-taking, will finance our development.

The fourth lever is the joint decision to work together to ensure our collective security and develop a strong defence industry for the future. Activating this lever requires putting an end to the fragmentation of our military spending and building a shared vision of our defence and security with our citizens as soon as possible.

Our schools, universities, researchers, engineers, artists and entrepreneurs have the will to take back control of inventing the future and regain artistic, technological and scientific leadership. Achieving this requires increased investment, acceleration of the ongoing transformation of our systems and a deliberate strategy to attract talent from around the world.

The time has come to develop the digital infrastructure that is essential to our collective sovereignty and key to harnessing the potential of artificial intelligence and quantum computing, putting it at the service of our fellow citizens and the future of an economy that is fair and rich in well-paid jobs.

We also have a strong foundation in public health with remarkable capacity for innovation, offering a unique opportunity to improve healthy quality of life and make health breakthroughs that benefit the world.

Our values, our culture, our social model, our rule of law, our sense of justice and our concern for the environment and climate make Europe a place of balance and quality of life. We also have common institutions – imperfect but stable, adaptable and resilient – capable of carrying out shared projects while respecting national and regional identities.

The ***Europa Power*** **Initiative** now brings together opinion leaders and civil society actors who want to take back control of our collective destiny. It is also open to those in Europe and beyond who reject an international order dictated solely by an imperialist vision of spheres of influence. This powerful and prosperous Europe must be built jointly by citizens, businesses, trade unions, civil society, European and national institutions, local authorities and international partners, regardless of their size or power, who are ready to cooperate in a spirit of respect and dialogue in the service of a better world.

This is the roadmap for the ***Europa Power Initiative***. We invite all those who wish to join us in building this positive agenda, with a tight schedule, and making Europe a systemic, global, sustainable and responsible power, putting citizens at the heart of its action. We propose establishing an annual meeting on power: the Europa Power Conference. Each edition will provide an opportunity to publicly measure progress, evaluate decisions that have been made and update the roadmap, so that the power agenda remains a living and verifiable process.

European power means a positive, innovative, free, attractive, social and humanist future. It cannot be taken for granted, it cannot be decreed, it must be built. It depends on our collective ability to come together and take action.